



GENERAL STUDIES

TREND ANALYSIS

(2016-2014)

S.No.	Chapter Name	2016 (I)	2015 (II)	2015 (I)	2014 (II)
1	History	19	19	20	12
2	Geography	18	24	24	20
3	Polity	16	18	21	5
4	Economy	18	13	8	24
5	General Knowledge	19	18	15	29
	Total	90	92	88	90

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HISTORY

After analysing the previous year question papers, we have noticed that around 12-15 questions are asked from the History section. From Ancient India, questions are asked from topics like Harappan civilization, Rig Vedic age, Mauryan age, Six Indian philosophies, Gupta age, Literature during Ancient era. Questions from Medieval India covers the topics like Delhi Sultanate, Mughal empire, Foreign travellers during medieval age, Maratha empire, Vijayanagar empire, Art, Architecture and Literature. From Modern India, questions are mainly asked from the Indian National Movement. Topics from World History asked in the paper includes American war of Independence, Russian revolution, French revolution, World Wars I and II.



PART I ANCIENT INDIA

THE PRE-HISTORY OR STONE AGE

The age, when the pre-historic man began to use stones for utilitarian purpose is termed as the **Stone age**. The Stone age is divided into four category—the Paleolithic age or the Old Stone age, the Mesolithic age or the Middle Stone age, the Neolithic age or the New stone age and the Chalcolithic age.

1. The Paleolithic Age

- The Paleolithic culture of India developed in the pleistocene period or the Ice age. The Paleolithic men belonged to the Negrito race. Homo Sapiens first appeared in the last phase of this age.
- Paleolithic men were hunters and food gatherers. They had no knowledge of agriculture, fire or pottery, they used tools of unpolished, undressed rough stones and lived in cave rock shelters. They are also called Quartzite men. In India, Uttar Bahini in the Jammu area has revealed early paleolithic artifacts in the upper Shiwaliks.
- According to the nature of the stone tools used by the people and change in the climate. This age is divided into three phases, like Early or Lower Paleolithic, Middle Paleolithic and Upper Paleolithic.

2. The Mesolithic Age

- It is a transition phase between the Paleolithic age and the Neolithic age. The Mesolithic people lived on hunting, fishing and food gathering. At a later stage they also domesticated animals.
- The characteristic tools of the Mesolithic age are microliths, pointed crescentic blades, scrapers etc made up of stones.
- Adamgarh in Madhya Pradesh and Bagor in Rajasthan provide the earliest evidence for the domestication of animals.
- The people of Paleolithic and Mesolithic ages practiced painting. Bhimbetka in Madhya Pradesh is a striking site of Pre-historic painting.

3. The Neolithic Age

- The people of this age used tools and improved implements of polished stone. They particularly used stone axes.
- The neolithic settlers were the earliest farming communities. They produced ragi and horse-gram (kulathi). They domesticated cattle, sheep and goats. They wove cotton and wool to make clothes. Hand made pottery and use of potter wheel first appears during the Neolithic age.
- Neolithic men lived in caves and decorated their walls with hunting and dancing scenes. They knew the art of making boats. In the later phase, people lived a more settled life and lived in circular and rectangular houses made of mud and reed. It is interesting that in Burzahom domestic dogs were buried with their masters in their graves.
- Koldihwa in Uttar Pradesh revealed a three fold cultural sequence i.e. Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Iron age. Mehrgarh in Balochistan is the oldest Neolithic site in Pakistan (7000 BC).
- Important sites include Chotanagpur region, Central India and South of the Krishna river. Belan valley of Vindhya and middle part of the Narmada valley shows all the three phases of Stone age.

4. The Chalcolithic Age

- The end of the Neolithic period saw the use of metals. Copper was the first metal to be used. Chalcolithic culture refers to the stone-copper phase. People also used hand-axes and other objects made up of copperware.
- Chalcolithic people were primarily rural communities. They domesticated animals and practised agriculture. They were not acquainted with burnt bricks and lived in thatched houses. They venerated the mother Goddess and worshipped the bull.

- The people of Chalcolithic culture were the first to use painted pottery. Black and red pottery painted with white line design was most popular. The ceramics obtained from Malwa is considered the richest among the Chalcolithic ceramics.
- Important sites of this phase are spread in Rajasthan, Maharashtra, West Bengal, Bihar, Madhya Pradesh etc.

INDUS VALLEY CIVILISATION

Indus Valley Civilisation is one of the four earliest civilisations of the world along with the civilisations of Mesopotamia, Egypt and China.

- The civilisation forms part of the Protohistory of India and belongs to the Bronze age. Also called Harappan civilisation because, first excavated site is Harappa.
 - **Time Period** According to Radio Carbon dating approximately 2350 BC, according to Wheeler 2500 BC-1500 BC.
 - **Extension** From W-E (1550 km) Sutkagen Dor in Balochistan (Pakistan) to Alamgirpur in Meerut (Uttar Pradesh). From N-S (1100 km) Manda (Jammu and Kashmir) in North to Daimabad (Maharashtra) in South.
- In Indus Valley Civilisation basic administration decisions were taken by group of people.

Town Planning

- It was not uniform. A unique feature was the grid system i.e. streets cutting across one another at right angles, dividing the town into large rectangular blocks.
- The towns were divided into two parts: upper part or citadel and lower part.
- The fortified **citadel** on the Western side housed public buildings and members of ruling class.
- Below the citadel on the Eastern side, lay the **lower town** inhabited by the common people.
- **Underground Drainage System** connected all houses to the street drains.
- **The Great Bath** (Mohenjodaro) It was used for religious bathing. Steps at either end lead to the surface. There were changing rooms alongside.
- **The Granaries** (Harappa) Six granaries in a row were found in the citadel at Harappa.
- Houses were made up of *burnt bricks*. They were often two or more storeyed, varied in size, with a square courtyard around, which had a number of rooms. Windows did not face the main streets. They had tiled bathrooms.
- **Lamp-posts** were erected at regular intervals. It indicates the existence of street lighting.

Major Harappan Sites, their Excavators and Findings

Name of Sites	Excavator(s)	Region/River	Excavational Findings
Harappa	Dayaram Sahni (1921)	Montgomery district of Punjab (Pakistan) on the left bank of the river Ravi	Rows of six granaries, stone <i>lingam</i> and <i>yoni</i> figurines, virgin goddess seal, wheat and barley in wooden mortar, nude dancing male and female made of stone, dancing Nataraja
Mohenjodaro	RD Banerjee (1922)	Larkana district in Sindh on the right bank of Indus (Pakistan)	Pashupati seal, bronze image of a dancing girl, three cylindrical seals, mother goddess figurines, seated male sculpture of the Priest King, the Great Granary and the Great Bath
Chanhudaro	M Gopal Majumdar, Mackey (1931)	Situated in Sindh on the bank of the Indus river	Shops of shell ornament makers, bead makers, metal workers (metals so, discovered were gold, silver, tin, copper etc.)
Kalibangan	A Ghosh (1953-60)	Situated in Rajasthan on the left bank of the river Ghaggar	Seven fire altars, a ploughed field, cylindrical seals, wheels of toy carts, houses with their own wells, black bangles
Rangpur	Rangnath Rao (1953-54)	Situated on the left bank of Mahi river (Gujarat)	Rice was cultivated
Ropar	YD Sharma (1953-54)	Situated in Punjab on the banks of the river Sutlej	Evidence of burying a dog with a human burial
Surkotada	JP Joshi (1954)	Situated in Kutch (Bhuj) (Gujarat)	Provides the first actual remains of horse bones, bead making shops
Lothal	Rangnath Rao (1957)	Situated in Gujarat on the confluence of the Sabarmati and Bhargava rivers near the Gulf of Cambay	Only site with an artificial brick dockyard, Persian Gulf seal, terracotta model of Egyptian mummies, sacrificial fire altar, remains of rice husk, the only other site with remains of rice husk being Rangpur (Ahmedabad)
Banawali	RS Bisht (1973)	Situated on the left bank of the river Saraswati	Terracotta model of the plough, good quality of barley
Dholavira	BB Lal (1959), RS Bisht (1990-91)	Situated in Gujarat in the Rann of Kutch	Giant reservoirs, dams and embankments unique water management systems, 10-alphabet sign board, Megalithic burials

Religion

The chief male deity was Pashupati Mahadeva (Proto shiva), which is represented on a seal surrounded by elephant, tiger, rhino and buffalo (all facing in different direction) and two deers appear at his feet.

- Female deity i.e. Mother Goddess—depicted in various style. Symbolic worship was also there—Phallus worship, Yoni worship.
- Evidence of fire worship was also found at Lothal, Kalibangan and Harappa. Animal (Unicorn Bull) and tree worship (*Pipal*) also found there.
- The harappans also believed in evil-powers and might have used amulets as protection against them.

Social Life

- It was a highly developed urban way of life. Society principally consisted of middle class urban people. Presence of various classes like priests, merchants, craftsmen, peasants and labourers can be seen.
- The dress of the men consisted of two garments, the upper and the lower cotton garments, which were generally used. Wool was also used. Different kinds of necklaces have been discovered. Bracelets were used quite commonly. The vanity case found at Harappa reveals, that the Harappan women knew the art of wall painting.
- They domesticated buffaloes, bulls, oxens, sheeps, asses, goats, elephants, pigs and dogs.
- Harappans produced wheat, barley, pulses etc. In some areas evidence of rice have been found.

Trade and Commerce

Internal (in India) as well as external (foreign) trade prevailed during Harappan Civilisation. No metallic money but barter system was practised.

- Agriculture, industry and forest produce provided the basis for internal and external trade.
- Weights and measure of Harappa were made of limestone, steatite etc. They were in the multiples of 16.
- The inter-civilisational trade is evident from the mention of word 'Meluha' (probably Indus valley) in the Sumerian literature. Mesopotamian cylindrical seals have been found from Mohenjodaro.

Art and Craft

- Harappans used stone tools and were well acquainted with bronze. Bronze was made by mixing copper (from Khetri) with tin.
- **Bead Making** and jewellery of gold, silver precious stone were made. Cotton fabrics were used in summers and woollen in winters.
- Both men and women were very fond of ornaments and dressing up.
- **Pottery** both plain (red) or painted (red and black) pottery was made. Pots were decorated with human figures, plants, animals and geometrical patterns and *ochre* was painted over it.
- **Seals** were made of steatite pictures of one horned bull, buffalo, tiger, rhinoceros, goat and elephant are found on the seals. They marked ownership of property.